



Information Architecture

Information architecture is the organization of shared information within digital products. It is the art and science of organizing and structuring content in a logical and user-friendly way. Information architecture design connects users with content and context.

The value of information architecture (IA)

Information Architecture focuses on achieving optimal user experience by adhering to the following:

- Content strategy
- User interface design
- Interaction design

Content strategy

Content-oriented and people-oriented components make up a content strategy.

Content-oriented components	People-oriented components
Identify goals and substance	Outline the roles and workflow
Determine structure	Identify policies and standards

Key steps in the content lifecycle

1. Audit and analysis
2. Strategy
3. Plan
4. Create
5. Maintain

Content creation leading practices

General

- Understand the organization's goals and user needs to create meaningful and relevant content
- Follow style guides for language and design to aid in learning and understanding
- Understand how users think and speak about a topic area/subject
- Communicate to people in a way that they understand



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Content

- Be purposeful in the content to include or exclude
- Content is consistently updated when available, otherwise, it is archived
- Content is accessible and users benefit from the information
- Content can be found whether internally, externally, or both
- Content defines requirements in overall design and structure

Organizational systems

There are two categories of **schemes**:

- Exact
- Subjective

There are three main organizational **structures**:

- Hierarchical
- Sequential
- Matrix

Architectural support systems

The goals of labeling are to:

- Convey a lot of information in just a few words that are familiar to users, using language they already use in their daily lives
- Show organization and navigation systems to the user
- Avoid the temptation to make up or use unfamiliar words to build interest, as these often come at an expense to navigation

Navigation systems provide movement from one piece of information to another. There are three primary ways to provide this movement:

- Structural
- Associative
- Utility

Searching systems helps users search for information within a product. There are six main search patterns:

- Exact
- Faceted
- Parametric
- Best first
- Pagination
- Auto-complete/Auto-suggest